Protect Your LinkedIn Profile

Follow this guide to stay visible on LinkedIn *without* being useful to scammers. Use this when: Updating your profile • Accepting connection requests • Reading unexpected LinkedIn messages

Lock Down the Account Itself

Use a strong, unique password

- Never reuse a password from another site
- Long > clever (your password manager is your friend)

Turn on Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

- Stops most account takeovers—even if your password is stolen.
- Never approve a login you didn't start.

Remove the "Reconnaissance" Data

Attackers don't want secrets. They want **context**.

Trim or generalize:

- Specific tools and platforms
- Internal team names or processes
- Details about access ("approver," "admin," "owner")
- "Just started" or "new role" signals

If it helps a stranger sound like they work with you, it doesn't belong.

Privacy Settings That Matter

Hide your connections list

Prevents pretexts like: "I saw you know Jane…"

Limit who can see your email address and phone number

Reduces scraping, spam, and impersonation attempts.

Restrict who can send you connection requests

Cuts down bot and scam accounts dramatically.

Disable "share profile changes" / activity broadcasts

Prevents attackers from learning when roles, teams, or responsibilities change.

Be Selective with Connection Requests

(Not everyone needs access to your network)

Before accepting:

- Does the profile look complete?
- Real work history? Real connections?
- Mutual contacts you actually recognize?

If something feels off, skip it. You're not being rude—you're being smart.

Treat Messages Like Email

Be cautious with:

- Links
- Attachments
- "Quick favors"
- Urgent requests involving money, access, or documents

Even if the message looks professional—verify before acting.

Be Wary of "Too Good to Be True" Offers

(Especially job-related)

Common red flags:

- High pay for vague roles
- Pressure to move fast
- Requests to continue the conversation off LinkedIn immediately

Always research the company and the person before engaging.

Clean Up Your Connections

Once or twice a year:

- Review your connections list
- Remove people you don't recognize or trust

Old connections are often how attackers stay invisible.

Report Suspicious Profiles or Messages

If something seems fake:

- Report it to LinkedIn
- Don't engage
- Don't investigate on your own

Fast reporting limits harm.

Keep It Professional

Never share:

- Personal contact details you don't want misused
- Financial info
- Sensitive personal data